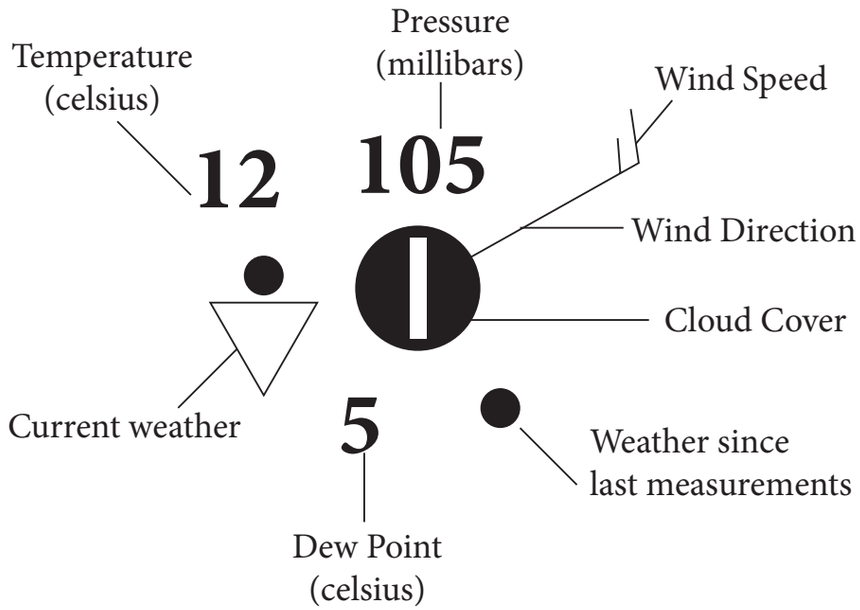


Figure 12.2 Station model

4. Pressure gradient denotes gentle or steepness based on the spacing of isobars. When the isobars are closely spaced the pressure gradient is steep and gentle if the isobars are widely spaced.

Wind Direction and Speed

1. In weather Map interpretation, wind barbs indicate wind direction and wind speed. The staff part shows wind direction. The staff is a line above the circle that indicates wind direction. The number and size of the feather and pennants included to the wind barb show the wind velocity.
2. Sky condition is represented using circle, shaded according to the cloud cover
3. Sea condition is shown as codes, for example, Ro- Rough.
4. Precipitation and temperature and the other weather data are generally tabulated and attached to the Indian daily weather map.

12.7 Weather Map Interpretation

The weather map is a symbolic representation of the atmospheric conditions of an area at a given time. On a weather map, you will find isobars and symbols related to pressure, direction and velocity of winds, clouds, precipitation and sea condition on a base map with political boundaries. These details are recorded at different weather stations at specified time.

Meteorological Departments forecast weather conditions by evaluating these weather elements shown on a weather map. This weather map is used in predicting weather conditions for a day, a week or a month in advance, which helps in taking precautions and safety measures. Weather forecasts help farmers, fishermen and crew of ships. It also helps air flights in predicting atmospheric condition a few hours ahead.

Weather maps are the collection of weather information from various meteorological stations pertaining to the

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